western half of which NATO troops operate but in the eastern half of which NATO cannot enter. And, therefore, we need other means. Because following them into their sanctuary in hot pursuit on the ground is not a possibility. Predator missiles occasionally, everyone understands that, but not ground pursuit.

I recommend strongly, Mr. Chairman, that your committee create a special oversight task force composed of your best staff that works 24/7 on AFPAK so that you on behalf of the American taxpayers know where the money you are appropriating goes. Last year you appropriated over $10 billion for Afghanistan. No one in this room could tell anyone where that money went. The short listing will tell you, for example, that $227 million went to alternative livelihoods. I have yet to meet anybody in Afghanistan who actually went into an alternative livelihood. Where did that money go? You do not know. I do not know. And I think it is worth pursuing.

There is a good idea on the table which I would like to put forward to you. It has been sponsored in your House by Chris Van Hollen and in the Senate by Maria Cantwell. It is called Reconstruction Opportunity Zones, ROZs. It is a way of creating in effect many free trade areas in the Tribal Areas of Pakistan which could create many jobs. I would recommend that that get high attention from your committee and that it gets positive consideration.

On the drug programs the money has been not only wasted, it has actually helped create Taliban and recruit both sides of the border.

On the media front the Afghan Government is clamping down on free media. I have with me today Saad Mohseni, the leader of the largest independent media organization in Afghanistan, Tolo TV. He is under intense pressure not to report things accurately, to cut out Indian soap operas and other things which are offensive to the most conservative elements. That is, in effect, the government yielding to pressure from people who are in cahoots with the Taliban.

So we need to do this comprehensively because the issue you raised taken out of context inevitably will lead to massive friction.

With your permission, sir, I really ought to go, if that is all right.

Chairman Berman. Okay.

Ambassador Holbrooke. Thank you for the great honor of being here today.

Chairman Berman. No, I apologize for the fractured meeting.

Ambassador Holbrooke. Tom, not for the first time Tom will speak for me whether I agree with him or not. We have been friends and associates now——

Chairman Berman. Yes.

Ambassador Holbrooke [continuing]. For over 30 years and there is no one I respect more in the Foreign Service. Thank you.

Chairman Berman. Great. Well, thank you for I mean coming. And I apologize again for all the distractions that just go along with being in this place.

Ambassador Pickring, do you have any thoughts you have on these questions?

Ambassador Pickring. Yes, I do. I totally agree with what Dick has said. It will be difficult to put together a unified plan in any short period of time. We have to recognize that.

Chairman Berman. Let me just interject one thing. Ambassador Holbrooke mentioned the Karzai-Pakistan, the relationship between the two. Based on one meeting I had with representatives of, a representative of the new government my sense is they think that relationship is going to get much better than the Musharraf-Karzai relationship.

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